

THEME

This story is about how a small girl named Komal, who comes from a poor family, got a chance to learn and grow just because someone cared enough to fix her Anganwadi center. At first, the center was in really bad shape, broken walls, no clean water, and not many kids came. Even Komal didn't go regularly. But then, an organization came and made everything better. They painted the place with bright colors, added fun drawings on the walls, and talked to parents about how important it is for kids to come and learn. Because of all this, Komal started going to the center happily. She began to play, learn colors, name body parts, and even say things like "A for Apple" at home. Her mom, who always wanted her daughters to study, felt really proud. So, the main idea of the story is: even small changes and love can help kids like Komal dream big and start learning with joy.

TITLE OF THE STORY

"From Silence to ABC: Komal's Little Steps"

ORGANIZATION

CRY (Child Rights And You)

BASIC INFORMATION ABOUT KOMAL

Name: Komal Kumari

Age: 5 years and 2 months

Sex: Female

Place (Anganwadi Center): Center Number 177

Community: Other Backward Class (OBC)

Caste: Teli (Baniya)

Father's Name: Lalu Sah

Mother's Name: Ranjana Kumari

Family Background: Economically weak: father runs a cart, mother is a homemaker

Siblings: One sister (two daughters in the family)

HER ACCESS TO SCHOOL

At first, Komal didn't go to her Anganwadi center regularly, even though her name was on the list. She went only 2-4 days a month. The center wasn't in good condition, there were torn mats, no clean drinking water, broken walls, and hardly any children came. It didn't feel like a place for learning. But after the organization repaired and painted the center, made it colorful with pictures, and talked to parents about why early learning matters, things started to change. Komal's mother began sending her regularly. Slowly, Komal started enjoying the center. She played with toys, learned colors from the wall art, began to name body parts, and even spoke English letters like "A for Apple" at home. Komal goes to the Anganwadi center by walking, sometimes with her mother and sometimes with the Anganwadi worker since the center is close to her home and the family doesn't have a vehicle. So now, Komal has real access to early education, a safe, fun, and colorful place to learn, grow, and enjoy being a child.

ABOUT HER FAMILY

Komal lives in a small family with her father, mother, and one sister so there are two daughters in the house. Her family belongs to the Teli (Baniya) caste, which is part of the Other Backward Class (OBC) group. Her father's name is
Lalu Sah.

He is not highly educated but can read and write a little. He earns money by running a cart on the streets, which is the only source of income for the family. Her mother's name is Ranjana Kumari. She is a homemaker and stays at home, taking care of the house and children. She is not educated but has a strong dream, she wants both of her daughters to get a good education and have a better life. The family does not own any farmland and their financial condition is not strong, but they live in a house built on a small piece of land they own. Even with all the struggles, there is love, care, and big hopes for the daughters' future.

BACKGROUND

Komal Kumari is a little girl of about 5 years and 2 months. She comes from a poor family that belongs to the Teli (Baniya) caste, which is part of the Other Backward Class (OBC). Her parents, Lalu Sah and Ranjana Kumari, can read and write a little but are not very educated. Komal has one sister, so there are two daughters in the family. They don't have any farmland, and their only home is built on a small piece of land they own. The family's money is very limited. Komal's father earns by running a small cart on the streets, and her mother is a homemaker who looks after the house and children. Even though her mother is not educated, she really wants her daughters to study and have a better future. At first, Komal didn't go to the Anganwadi center regularly because the place was not welcoming, there were broken walls, no clean water, and hardly any other children. But after the center was fixed and painted with bright colors, and after workers spoke with parents about how important early learning is, Komal started coming more often. Now, Komal is slowly learning and enjoying going to the center, playing with toys, recognizing colors, and starting to speak simple words and letters. Her family's hope is that she will keep learning and grow up to have a better life.

PROBLEM IDENTIFICATION

Komal Kumari faced many challenges that made it hard for her to go to school regularly. The Anganwadi center where she was enrolled was in very bad shape. The mats for children to sit on were torn, and there was no clean drinking water available, so the kids had to fetch water themselves from a hand pump. The walls around the center were broken, and the main gate was almost falling apart. The toilet was dirty and in very poor condition, with overgrown bushes blocking the way to it. There were no chairs for the workers, and only a few children came to the center. Because of this, Komal didn't want to go often and attended only a few days each month. Besides, her family was poor and couldn't afford a private school for her. Also, her parents didn't fully understand the importance of early

education, so they didn't push her to attend regularly. All these problems made it difficult for Komal to start learning early.

PROBLEM INTERVENTION

The project team started by tracking children like Komal who were at risk of dropping out, not coming regularly, or facing problems like malnutrition or child labor. They noticed Komal was only coming a few days a month, which was a concern. Sometimes, children or community members shared their worries about issues like child marriage or irregular attendance with the project staff. The team then reached out to Komal's parents through home visits and counseling sessions. They explained why it was so important for Komal and her sister to go to the Anganwadi center regularly and how early education would help them in life. The project staff also involved community members and local influencers to support these messages and encourage parents to send their children to school. The turning point came when Komal's mother understood the value of education and began bringing her to the center regularly. With the team's continued support and the community's encouragement, Komal started enjoying learning. She played with toys, learned colors, and even spoke simple words.

Now, Komal's attendance is regular, and her parents feel proud of her progress. The project team's efforts brought a big positive change in Komal's life and her family's mindset.

OVERALL IMPACT OF THE PROJECT

The project made a big difference in Komal's life and many other children in the community. Before, the Anganwadi center was broken and not welcoming, so very few kids came. But after the team fixed the center, painted it with bright colors, and talked to parents, more children started coming regularly. Komal's mother said, "We are a poor family and can't afford private schools. This center is the only school for our children.

What the organization has done is really good."The project helped parents understand how important early education is, and they began sending their children to learn and play at the center. Komal also changed a lot. She said, "I like playing with toys here and learning about colors and body parts." She even started saying simple words like "A for Apple" at home, which made her parents very happy. Thanks to the project, Komal is now going to the center every day, learning new things, and enjoying her time there. The

project brought hope and a better future for Komal and many children like her in the community.